Revised Team Contract

Names: Victor Alfaro, Christian Santiago, Sangeon Jeon, Christopher Semali

Mutual Expectations:

Behavior to Avoid: Identify disruptive or unproductive behaviors that you agree to avoid.

Close mindedness as a team as we work towards to be completely transparent with each other. Punctual and on time to team meetings and being transparent with our deadlines. Most of all transparency with everything pertaining to the project. Open to conflict resolution as a group. Project notes of how each member works and what they worked on/what they were thinking on how to contribute to the team so all members can see and understand any changes. Not being open to new ideas when presented with them is something that should be avoided due to it causing roadblocks in progression. Be more definitive in writing on the shared notebook on what everyone is progressing towards as we need to keep a log for the professor to see accountability.

Communication: Determine how your group will communicate with each other (eg. Email, Slack, Teams, Groupme, texting, etc.). Is there someone who wants to coordinate communications?

We will be utilizing group text messaging as the main form of communication, along with inclusion of GitHub for program revision control. We will use teams for virtual meetings in the event there is a matter to attend to rapidly. In terms of information sharing, we will utilize the full capabilities of Microsoft teams since it has a wide variety of features that make working on documents together a lot easier and smoother.

Workflows: Determine when you will meet (make sure that everyone is available at that time), what will be the purposes of those meetings, if there will be subgroup meetings, and any directions on how the meetings will be run.

We will be having meetings on the days that we have class/studio which will be in person or remote if the class that specific day was held remotely. This does not include group messages that are exchanged not in a formal meeting time. The main purpose of the meetings is to discuss the progress that was made by each section of the group and as a group deciding what needs to be done in every category and coming up with solutions for rising problems. All communication will take place in the group chat, but individual groups will communicate with each other through direct SMS. We will start with progress made, the goal being progressed to, and concerns that can be resolved by a team discussion on the overall design. We usually end with planning until the next meeting and what needs to be done.

Conflicts: How will you handle conflicts for people who do not abide by this contract?

We will have a group discussion and meeting discussing the importance of the work we are doing individually and the emphasis on how we work as a team. If we still have issues with each other, we will seek out advice from the main instructor on how to proceed. If it comes down to design decisions, we will take a group vote where majority wins as a resolution matter that we all agree on, this is how the project idea was chosen. Conflict resolution on our end if the instructor is our last resort will be either through text or in person. Mediation will be done in a non-aggressive manner but in a calm and collective way.

Omicron special: How will you handle hybrid meetings (what medium? What modified practices will you adopt)?

We will primarily be using in-person meetings as our main source of progress reporting but will be utilizing Microsoft Teams video calls when we need to meet in a hybrid manner. Our main source of communication would be group SMS to assign extra meeting days if we are not able to reach our weekly checkpoints.

Assignments: To be done after initial discussion on the project. Go around the group to determine what people would like to do and why (ie, they have interest or skill at it). Do not automatically assign a task to the first person who volunteers.

The consensus of the group is that Christopher has strong skills in programming and debugging, Christian would like to work on the electrical and mechanical component of the project, Victor will primarily focus on the electrical components and subsystem, and Jeon would like to primarily focus on the mechanical aspect. We all feel comfortable with this choice as we all picked in terms of wanting to learn more or hone our pre-existing skills.

Who will do what? Does this align with people's skillset and interests? Can the assignments be done concurrently? What kind of interaction is needed with other team members (who and how managed)?

We have decided to prioritize individual's skills and interests but also include learning aspects such as PCB design, embed design, soldering skills, and 3D modeling. We have it set for the team to work on all the aspects concurrently, but it seems we all have experience in multiple categories so advice when we meet would be extremely sufficient. Interaction between team members is crucial especially in the integration phase where all subsystems need to work seamlessly. Collaboration is heavily needed and has been heavily used in meetings to allow more than one set of eyes to confirm certain aspects of the project.

Teamwork Questionnaire Responses:

Add in any modifications that would improve the team's performance after the Effective Team Dynamics exercise this week

-1. Identify at least two items from the teamwork questionnaire that you need to improve upon, and specifically copy the wording from the questionnaire into your team contract along with a plan to improve.

1. ***Team meetings generally begin 5-15 minutes late. Members often arrive late, leave early, or never even show up for meetings.***

The first item that we need to improve on is punctuality. There have been a few times where members have arrived late or never showed. This can be circumvented with contact prior in the group chat to let everyone know what has happened or the reasoning. A phone call would be ideal so we can vocally hear what exactly the situation that arose is.

2. ***Assignments are not completed on time or are completed poorly.***

The second item would be assignments not being completed. There was some miscommunication on the CDR deliverable that led to one section being left blank upon turn in. In the future, we plan to vocally express each of our tasks so we can all be on the same page on what each member will do.

-2. Using your insight from the effective team dynamics lecture, identify 2 additional items and your plan to improve. Highlight or underline these items as well to make them stand out.

From the effective team dynamics lecture we could do two additional items to improve our effective team dynamics.

1. We could Encourage testing. There have been times where we have tried to offer opposing views, but they were not taken seriously or there was a disconnect due to a misunderstanding. We could improve this by listening empathetically and making our initiation inviting with no hostility whatsoever. The group can then take these opposing viewpoints and take them into consideration.
2. In these last two weeks, we can S.T.A.T.E , which will come into effect in our last two weeks of project work. We need to hold accountability for each task group members will have in a vocal and very clear manner. We have been doing this for most of the semester but there have been cases where there have been misunderstandings on who does what. Since this is a critical two weeks, a proper understanding will be absolutely necessary.